



perform not just for myself but for India. A strong showing at the Para Athletics World Championships would be a big step for our country. I want the para sports movement to grow, to inspire more athletes, and to change more lives — just as sports changed mine.

I was in Class 11, in 2011, when an accident damaged my spinal cord. At first, I couldn't move my hands, get up from bed, or even breathe without support. At 16, I thought my life was over. Just when I was supposed to take flight, my wings were broken.

It took time to accept that I had no movement below my chest. My parents were my pillars — they never

let me dwell on what I'd lost. They told me I could still build a meaningful life, whether I chose to work, study, or pursue something else. They only wanted me to be happy and financially secure.

Ironically, I might never have entered sports without my injury. Before it, I hadn't dreamed of being an athlete. Even after the accident, I planned to study, get a stable job as an engineer or CA, and secure my future. But over time, I felt I wanted more. I didn't want to blend into the crowd. I wanted to do something distinctive.

I tried para sports in 2018 under coach Giriraj Singh sir at Faridabad stadium. That's where I discovered

club throw. Because my fingers couldn't grip the club, I had to use gum to make it stick to my palm. It was tough, but within weeks I loved it. My life before sports felt like living in a cage. When I came to the stadium, I finally felt alive.

I won bronze at Nationals, then silver at my first international competition — the 2019 Beijing Grand Prix. But the reality was harsh. I wasn't earning anything.

My parents, not wealthy to begin with, took loans to fund my training and travel. I could only train on Sundays, when my father was free from work to take me. Despite working hard, I couldn't see a future in sport. So, in 2020, after I got a